

SAMI ALI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student with hands-on experience supporting the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) as a Vulnerability Assessment Team (VAT) intern at CBP. CompTIA Security+ and AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner with experience in vulnerability management, threat analysis, and cybersecurity operations, including KEV-based risk prioritization aligned with CISA directives. Skilled in analyzing vulnerabilities and indicators of compromise (IOCs) across enterprise environments, with strong analytical and communication skills and a passion for cybersecurity.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Compliance Documentation & Technical Writing • NIST CSF & NIST SP 800-171 • CMMC / FedRAMP • Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) • Security Policy Development • Compliance Metrics & Reporting • Vulnerability Assessment • CVE / CVSS Analysis • MITRE ATT&CK • Zero Trust Architecture • Windows & Linux • Python • Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint) • Meeting Facilitation & Action Tracking • Cross-Functional

CERTIFICATIONS & CLEARANCES

Certifications: CompTIA Security+ (DoD 8570) | AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

Clearance: CBP Full Background Investigation (BI) — Active | U.S. Citizen

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Vulnerability Assessment Team Analyst Intern | Dept. of Homeland Security | Ashburn, VA | May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Led an end-to-end Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) research project, matching enterprise-wide Nessus/Tenable scan results against the CISA KEV Catalog and benchmarking remediation performance against CISA BOD 26-04 to identify outlier systems and aged-finding backlogs.
- Built a multi-page Power BI dashboard integrating CVSS, EPSS, and remediation-age metrics, demonstrating that exploitation likelihood — not severity alone — distinguishes real-world risk, and presented findings through an executive briefing to technical and leadership audiences.
- Designed a risk-based prioritization methodology weighing KEV status, asset criticality (HVA), internet exposure, EPSS, and CVSS to guide enterprise remediation under federal directives.
- Drafted technical compliance reports on vulnerability findings and remediation recommendations, supporting operations aligned with the NIST Cybersecurity Framework, FedRAMP, and Zero Trust architecture.

PROJECTS

Phishing IOC Extractor — Python CLI

- Designed and built a Python command-line tool that parses raw RFC 822 (.eml) phishing samples and extracts five categories of indicators of compromise — IPv4 addresses, domains, URLs, email addresses, and MD5/SHA-1/SHA-256 hashes — using tuned regex patterns; outputs deduplicated, sorted JSON for downstream threat-intel enrichment.
- Implemented argparse CLI with pretty-print and file-output flags, robust error handling, type hints, and docstrings throughout. Authored a 10-test pytest suite covering each extractor function and edge cases (empty input, deduplication, case normalization) — all tests passing.

Network Traffic Analysis Lab — Wireshark

- Captured and analyzed live network traffic across five protocol scenarios — TCP three-way handshake, DNS query/response, HTTP request, TLS Client Hello (SNI), and ARP request/reply — demonstrating cross-layer protocol literacy from L2 through L7.
- Documented analyst-relevant indicators including SNI visibility for SOC monitoring of encrypted HTTPS traffic and ARP-cache poisoning signatures (MITRE ATT&CK T1557.002), with full README explaining each capture and its defender relevance

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Information Technology | Minor: Cybersecurity

George Mason University | Expected May 2028 |

Associate of Science, Information Technology

Northern Virginia Community College | May 2026 | GPA: 3.7